

8.4b

Dealing with complaints

Worksheet

D Complete the table by writing supplier phrases 1,2,4,5,6 and 8 from section A in the correct category.

Ask questions	Is it still under guarantee? (a) _____
You are unable to help	We can't really help you, I'm afraid. Have you tried contacting the insurance company? (b) _____ _____
Apologize and explain	Really? Right, I see, I'm very sorry. This has never happened before. It's probably just a computer error. (c) _____ _____
Promise action	Can you leave it with me? I'll look into it and get back to you. (d) _____ _____
End a phone call	If you have any more problems, please let me know. (e) _____
Make a follow-up call	I can assure you we're doing everything we can. (f) _____ _____

- Notice how you use *will*, in its abbreviated form, to promise action. How many examples can you find in the phrases above?
- Find a phrase in the table that means *I'll investigate the problem and I'll call you again*.

E Work with a new partner and make four telephone calls. Take turns to be customer and supplier. Before each call, decide together what the product is. The supplier may have to make a follow-up call if he/she can't deal with the problem immediately.

- Customer:** You ordered 2000 pieces. This morning 1000 were delivered.
Supplier: Your factory is very busy at the moment.
- Customer:** You received all the goods you ordered, but some are damaged.
Supplier: The goods were in perfect condition when they left your factory.
- Customer:** You received delivery of some machines this morning. You have tested one of the machines and it is not working properly.
Supplier: Your machines are excellent quality and it is very rare to have problems. You have a technician available but he has a full schedule tomorrow.
- Customer:** You recently received delivery of 5000 items. This morning the invoice arrived in the post and there is a mistake.
Supplier: You recently installed some new accounts software in your computers. Your staff are being trained how to use it at the moment.

F Practise the situations in section B again. Work with a new partner and this time make telephone calls.

